

The Future Drought Fund has partnered with Nuffield Australia to support farmers who want to learn more about drought resilience. Through this program, selected scholars travel across Australia and overseas to study how farmers can better prepare for drought and meet experts who are leading change in agriculture. Scholars share what they learn with their peers and communities to strengthen Australian agriculture.

The first stage of the program provided \$1.6 million for 10 scholarships in 2024 and 2025 and supported all Nuffield scholars to take part in drought-related activities.

In 2024, the program received an additional \$3.2 million to continue for four more years. From 2026 to 2029, up to 20 drought resilience scholarships will be awarded. All Nuffield scholars will also be supported to build their knowledge in drought resilience.

Learn more about [Nuffield Australia](#) and its [scholars](#).

2026 Nuffield Australia Drought Resilience Scholars

- Jessica Bidgood (QLD) – studying how grazing practices can improve soil, save water and help nature thrive.
- Blythe Calnan (WA) – exploring the relationship between livestock handling and resilience to drought.
- Isobel Heffernan (NT) – studying community-led climate resilience.
- Kristen Hegarty (NSW) – looking at improving drought and climate resilience through business diversification.
- Kate Watts (QLD) – investigating livestock traceability tools to improve drought decision-making.

2025 Nuffield Australia Drought Resilience Scholars

- Jock Barnett (NSW) – studying how growing and diversifying farm businesses affects drought resilience.
- Tyson Cattle (WA) – looking at global agriculture organisations and industries, and how they inform drought preparedness.
- Lucy Dodd (SA) – exploring ways small poultry farms can adapt and improve their resilience to drought.
- Kari Moffat (QLD) – investigating how commitments to sustainability affect decision-making and influence drought resilience.
- Hamish Robertson (VIC) – researching financial resilience through drought and hard economic times.

2024 Nuffield Australia Drought Resilience Scholars

- Caitlin Herbert (NSW) – exploring cattle feedlots role in ‘drought-proofing’ Australia’s livestock production.
- Michael Taylor (NSW) – developing the culture and skills for agroforestry in grazing and cropping regions.
- Claudia Benn (QLD) – researched strengthening resilience through ecological literacy, connection and community.
- Ben Poschelk (QLD) – looking at building farmer drought resilience in the face of a changing climate.
- Natalie Schlitz (VIC) – investigating the viability of the Australian fodder export sector in a water-limited future.

The 2024 Nuffield drought resilience scholar cohort presented their research at Nuffield Australia’s national conference in September 2025. Their reports will be published in 2026.

Read the published [Nuffield drought resilience scholars reports](#).

Case studies

Hear our scholars share their ideas to help farmers get ready for future droughts.

Reports

Nuffield Australia scholar cohort	Scholar name	Final report	Published
2024	Claudia Benn	Building resilience through ecological literacy, connection and community (PDF 3.6 MB)	July 2026
		Building resilience through ecological literacy, connection and community (Word 18 MB)	
2024	Caitlin Herbert	Lotfeeding for the long haul: strengthening Australia’s beef supply chain through climate extremes (PDF 1 MB)	August 2026
		Lotfeeding for the long haul: strengthening Australia’s beef supply chain through climate extremes (Word 1 MB)	

If you have difficulty accessing any of these files, please email DRScholarships@aff.gov.au.

Funding information

Find details of the payment information for Drought Resilience Scholarship Program as required under section 27A of the Future Drought Fund Act 2019 below.

Further information

For further information on the Drought Resilience Scholarship program please contact DRScholarships@aff.gov.au

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/drought/future-drought-fund/drought-resilience-scholarship-program>